

0
species named

0
times I wouldn't say

Photograph a mushroom

WHAT THIS APP WILL NOT DO

It will never tell you a mushroom is safe to eat. There is no such category in it. It names what it can and warns about recorded hazards; where there is no hazard on record it says nothing at all, because silence is the honest answer and cannot be misread as permission.

It will refuse rather than guess. If two species that look alike from a photograph are in play and one of them can kill, it names neither. That is the app working, not failing — and it is the whole difference between this and the apps that answer every time.

It cannot see what you did not photograph. The base of the stem and the underside of the cap are where most answers are, and they are the parts almost everyone leaves in the ground.

GETTING A USEFUL ANSWER

- Lever the whole mushroom out rather than cutting it. The base matters and it is easy to lose.
- Photograph the cap, the side and the underside. Each one rules things out that the others cannot.
- Daylight beats indoor light for colour, and colour separates species that otherwise look identical.

Someone has eaten a wild mushroom — what to do

Never eat a wild mushroom identified only by an app

Home Observe Me

Someone has eaten a wild mushroom — what to do

Before you use this

This app exists because the other ones answer every question. It will often tell you that it cannot identify what you have photographed, and that is the app working, not failing.

It will never tell you that a mushroom is safe to eat. No app can. People are killed every year by mushrooms that were identified confidently and wrongly, and the species responsible have ordinary lookalikes that experienced foragers collect on purpose.

- [x] **I understand this app will never tell me a mushroom is safe to eat.**

  There is no such category in it. It names what it can and warns about recorded hazards. Where there is no hazard on record it says nothing at all, which is not the same as saying it is safe.

- [x] **I understand a photograph cannot rule out a deadly lookalike.**

  The features that separate the dangerous species from their ordinary lookalikes are usually underground, underneath, or only visible hours later in a spore print.

- [x] **I will not eat a wild mushroom on the strength of what this app tells me.**

  An identification here is a starting point for a person who already knows what they are doing, and nothing more than that.

- [x] **I understand this build has no trained model, and the identifications it produces are placeholders.**

  The classifier has not been trained yet. Results come from a stub that produces consistent but meaningless answers, so that everything around it can be built and tested.

- [x] **I understand the percentages shown are not probabilities.**

  Calibration has not been fitted. Until it is, a number is an ordering between candidates and nothing more -- 80% does not mean eight times in ten.

- [x] **I understand the reference data has not been checked by a mycologist.**

  Which species are dangerous, which are confused with which, and what separates them are compiled from standard references and have not been reviewed by a qualified person. Errors in that data become errors in every answer.

I understand — continue

Kept on this phone. There is no account and nothing is uploaded.

What did you see?

Every field is optional. Answer only what you actually observed -- a guess is worse than a blank, because the app cannot tell the two apart.

SURROUNDINGS

What trees are within about ten metres?

Oak | Beech | Birch | Pine or spruce | Larch | Mixed broadleaf | No trees nearby

Leave blank if you're not sure

WHAT IT IS GROWING ON

What is it growing on or out of?

Soil or leaf litter | Dead wood or a stump | A living tree | Grass or lawn | Dung | Moss

Leave blank if you're not sure

GROWTH HABIT

How is it growing?

Singly | Scattered | In a tight cluster | In a ring | As a bracket

Leave blank if you're not sure

CAP COLOUR

What colour is the cap?

White or cream | Yellow | Orange | Red | Pink | Brown | Olive or greenish | Grey | Purple | Black

Leave blank if you're not sure

GILL COLOUR

What colour are the gills right now?

White | Pink | Violet or lilac | Brown | Chocolate or black | Yellow or green | Grey

Leave blank if you're not sure

RING ON THE STEM

Is there a ring or skirt of tissue on the stem?

Firm skirt-like ring | Cobwebby fibres | Faint zone only | No ring

Leave blank if you're not sure

SMELL

What does it smell like?

Pleasantly mushroomy | Aniseed or almond | Apricot or fruity | Fresh bread dough | Radish | Raw potato or earthy | Soap | Coconut | Ink or chemicals | Rotting or foul | Nothing much

Leave blank if you're not sure

SPORE PRINT only if you already have one

What colour is the spore print?

White or cream | Pink | Rust or cinnamon brown | Chocolate or purple-brown | Black | Olive or yellow

Leave blank if you're not sure

Identify

← What I can tell you



A SPECIES THAT CAN KILL IS AMONG THE POSSIBILITIES

This doesn't match anything I know well

The photograph does not resemble any species in my range with reasonable confidence. It may be a species I was never trained on, or the photograph may not show enough of the mushroom.

This model has not been calibrated. Treat the percentages below as rough ordering only, not as probabilities.

CHECK THIS BEFORE ANYTHING ELSE

SPORE SURFACE — Look now

What carries the spores underneath?

This would help confirm or rule out Byssomerulius corium.

Photograph the underside close up.

- Gills
- Pores
- Spines
- Smooth surface
- Ridges

I can't tell / skip this

2 more questions after this

POSSIBILITIES

Psilocybe semilanceata Liberty Cap — Causes illness	14%
Mycena galopus Milking Bonnet	10%
Amanita excelsa Grey Spotted Amanita	5%
Byssomerulius corium Netted Crust	4%
Trametes versicolor Turkeytail	3%
Cortinarius rubellus Deadly Webcap — Can kill	3%
Russula fragilis Fragile Brittlegill — Causes illness	2%
Phaeotremella foliacea Leafy Brain	2%

Because this does not match anything I know, I cannot tell you what it is -- and I cannot rule out that it is one of the species that can kill. Treat an unidentified mushroom as more dangerous than a named one, not less.

One or more candidates for this photograph are species that can kill. Do not eat this mushroom. A photograph cannot rule these out.

This app identifies possibilities, not certainties, and never tells you whether something is safe to eat. Never eat a wild mushroom identified only by an app.

Saved to your observations, on this phone.

← What I can tell you



A SPECIES THAT CAN KILL IS AMONG THE POSSIBILITIES

This doesn't match anything I know well

The photograph does not resemble any species in my range with reasonable confidence. It may be a species I was never trained on, or the photograph may not show enough of the mushroom.

This model has not been calibrated. Treat the percentages below as rough ordering only, not as probabilities.

CHECK THIS BEFORE ANYTHING ELSE

CAP COLOUR — Look now

What colour is the cap?

This is what separates Psilocybe semilanceata from Mycena galopus.

Photograph from above in natural light, avoiding deep shade.

- White or cream
- Yellow
- Orange
- Red
- Pink
- Brown
- Olive or greenish
- Grey
- Purple
- Black

I can't tell / skip this

2 more questions after this

POSSIBILITIES

Psilocybe semilanceata Liberty Cap — Causes illness	15%
Mycena galopus Milking Bonnet	11%
Amanita excelsa Grey Spotted Amanita	5%
Byssomerulius corium Netted Crust	5%
Cortinarius rubellus Deadly Webcap — Can kill	3%
Russula fragilis Fragile Brittlegill — Causes illness	3%
Phaeotremella foliacea Leafy Brain	2%
Amanita pantherina Panther Cap — Causes serious illness	2%

Because this does not match anything I know, I cannot tell you what it is -- and I cannot rule out that it is one of the species that can kill. Treat an unidentified mushroom as more dangerous than a named one, not less.

One or more candidates for this photograph are species that can kill. Do not eat this mushroom. A photograph cannot rule these out.

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Saved to your observations, on this phone.

This is wrong — tell me why

1 observation · stored on this phone only



Today

Not recognised as anything I know

1 thing to know about this record

Delete the whole log

Making a spore print

It takes a few minutes to set up and several hours to develop. It is the most decisive test you can do without a microscope.

1. Cut the cap off, as close under the cap as you can.
2. Lay it gills-down on paper that is half white and half black. A sheet of each, side by side, works.
3. Cover it with a bowl or a glass so draughts cannot disturb it.
4. Leave it somewhere still for two to twelve hours. Overnight is easiest.

The half-and-half paper matters twice over: a pale print is invisible on white and a dark one is invisible on black, and the white half also lets the app correct for the colour of your kitchen light when it reads the photograph.

It's set up — start the timer

You can close the app. The timer keeps running.

If someone has eaten a wild mushroom

Call 999
Seriously unwell

Call 111
Advice, any hour

1 **Call now — do not wait for symptoms**
In the UK: 999 if someone is seriously unwell, NHS 111 otherwise. Amatoxin poisoning has a latent period of six to twenty-four hours, and someone who feels fine may already need treatment. Early treatment substantially improves the outcome.

2 **Take the mushroom with you**
Whatever is left of it, including scraps, peelings and anything in the bin. Keep it dry and in paper rather than plastic. A photograph is a poor substitute for the specimen, and identification by a mycologist changes the treatment.

3 **Say what was eaten, when, and how much**
The time of the meal matters as much as the species, because the gap between eating and the first symptom is itself diagnostic. Take a note of it before you leave.

4 **Do not rely on anything this app told you**
Including a reassuring answer. This app cannot assess whether a mushroom is safe to eat and has never claimed to.